

Variables to Consider for Plyometric Training Programs

Variable	Explanation
Training age	More experienced athletes will be able to perform more challenging exercises such as weighted, band-resisted, and single-leg options.
Body mass	The total body mass of the client or athlete can alter the difficulty of exercises such as depth jumps and multiple-plane hops.
Surface	Softer surfaces such as grass and sand can minimize ground reaction forces from landing. Harder surfaces such as rubber floors and courts can maximize the elastic response in more advanced exercises.
Availability of equipment	Lack of plyometric equipment such as hurdles, boxes, or medicine balls will decrease the possible variation of exercises.
Time of training	Exercise selection can vary based on when training will occur, such as before, during, or after resistance training; between warm-ups; or on its own developmental session.
Seasonal priority	Frequency, intensity, and duration are dependent on which season the athlete is training in.
Planes of motion	Exercise selection varies based on which planes of motion need the most support or development. This can help maximize the transfer of training effects and/or reduce the risk of future injury.
Range of motion	Sport-specific joint angles and muscle actions take greater precedence as the athlete moves closer to competition.
Speed of drill	Greater speeds, especially during repeated or explosive tempos, will affect the difficulty of the drill.
Duration/frequency	Limited time during the sessions or the total number of sessions will influence the types of exercises selected.
Rest	The lengths of both intra- and inter-set rest periods can affect energy system utilization and primary goals.